

Spiritual Gifts: One Body, Many Parts

ገጽ 70 ከ 80

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam
Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 70 of 80

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Ab Qorontos zineberet bete kristiyan ab qedameyti kristiyanawi alem kab zi'abeya wihbet zinebera maHberat Hanti neberet — kem'u'win kab zibezHe ziteKefafelet Hanti. Kulu ziHiseb menfesawi wihbet neberan, tinbit, lisanat, mifiwas, Tibeb, filiTet. Ginake nezan wihbetat niHadiHdom nimhinats' zigebir nimwiddar yiTqemuleyn neberu.

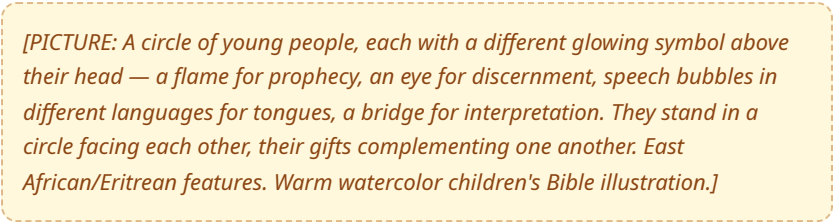
Zitefelalaye aynet wihbetat alo, ginake zi'idlo Hade Menfes iyu. Pawlos bezi seretawi Haqi yijmir: bizuHnet wihbetat kab Hadnet minChi yifesis. Wihbetat bigrum zitefelaleya iyen — kem Hibirtat qeste debena zitefelaleya — ginake kulen kab Hade Menfes yimets'a. Izi malet zikone wihbet tiHut wey li'ul aykonen.

Nazi kulu gina Hadei nisun Menfes yi'ayo, kem zideliyo ninefsi wekef biHade biHade yi'idil. Izi Tiqsi nay seb kur'at yiferis. Wihbetat bimenfesawi awet ayreKhbun. Nay "aKhali miwKhan" shilmat aykonu'n. Bitqebali aymirets'un. Menfes Qidus nisu kem ziwsin wihbetat yi'idil — biTibebe, bi'elamu, siga intay kem zedliyo bifits'um filiTetu.

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*Pawlos wihbetat yizirzir zisdemim bizuHneten nimri'ay: "niHade biMenfes qal Tibeb
yiweHabo, niKhal'e biHade Menfes qal filiTet yiweHabo, niKhal'e biHade Menfes imnet
yiweHabo, niKhal'e biHade Menfes wihbet mifiwas yiweHabo, niKhal'e Hayli
te'amirat." Tibeb Haqi Amlak ab ziteHalaLeKe kunetat nay mitigbar Ki'let iyu.*

Scene 5 of 25



Paul continues the list: "to another prophecy, to another distinguishing between spirits, to another speaking in different kinds of tongues, and to still another the interpretation of tongues." Prophecy is speaking God's message to His people — encouragement, correction, direction from the heart of God. Distinguishing spirits (discernment) is the ability to recognize whether something is from God, from human invention, or from the enemy — critically needed in an age of deception. Speaking in tongues is a Spirit-given language of prayer or praise that bypasses the rational mind. Interpretation makes tongues understandable to the community. Notice how these gifts work together: prophecy needs discernment to test it; tongues need interpretation to benefit others. No gift is complete alone. Each one requires the others to function fully. God designed gifts to create interdependence — to make us need each other, draw us together rather than apart.

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Pawlos zirizru yiqTs'il: "niKhal'e tinbit, niKhal'e mililay menafisti, niKhal'e zitefalelaye aynet lisanat mizrab, niKhal'e dima tirigum lisanat." Tinbit meliKhti Amlak nihizbu mizrab iyu — kab libi Amlak mitibba'e, mi'iram, anfet. Mililay menafisti Hade neger kab Amlak, kab nay seb mihizo wey kab ts'ela'i miwKhanu nay miflaT ki'let iyu.

Nazi kulu gina Hadei nisun Menfes yi'ayo, kem zideliyo ninefsi wekef biHade biHade yi'idil. Pawlos nezi Haqi yidegmo mikniyatu qeliTifu sle ziris'a'e. Hayal wihbet zelew se b mis niri'i wihbet zihabe Menfes zeykone neti se b kinil'il niqne. Hid'at wihbet zelew se b mis niri'i ab mi'idal Tibe b Menfes kenKhbir zeykone kinini'qo niqne.

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*Siga Hade koyu bizuH akalat kem zelew, bizuHat akalat siga koyu gina Hade
siga kem zikonu kem'u Kristos dima kem'u iyu. Hiji Pawlos aziyu Hayal misla
yete'atatu. Bete kristiyan — kulom aminti biHansab — mis siga seb yimisaselo.
SigaKha kindey zigerim miwKhanu Hiseb — bilyonat wahyotat, ama'it ats'mitat,
deriznat akalat siga, maylis nay dem sir'at — kulu bizey miHisabKa'kwa ab fits'um
miwihad yiserH.*

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Ayni ni'id 'aydilyenin' kitbil aytiKh'ilin! Pawlos fluyin asiHagin yiKhewn. AyniKha — nimri'ay aziya agedasit, alem biKemey kem timelales ma'ikel — kab idiKa nats'net kite'wij Hiseb. "Bizey ni'aKha ts'ibuq kiri'i yiKh'il!" ayni kitbil tiKh'il nebere. Ginake nizri'yo kitzirigH mis zeytKh'il miri'ay intay yiTeqim?

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Ri'isi dima ni'igri 'aydilyenin' kitbil aytiKh'ilin! Pawlos anfet yiqyir. "ZiteHate" kifalat tiray zeykone zeyedli koynu kism'om ziKh'il — "zi'abeye" kifalat'win bizey zibezHe tiHut kiserHu ayKh'ilun. Ri'isi — mimiraH, anfet, wisane miwsan ziwkil — bizey igri nab zikone bota kiKeyd ayKh'ilin.

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Bi'anTs'aru itom nay siga kifalat ziDeKhemu ziMislu ziyada adleyti iyom. Izi weg'enya iyu. ZiDeKhemu ziMislu kifalat biHaqi bizeyom kitinebir zeytKh'il iyom. Hisebo: bizey ts'abi'e, bizey izni, bizey ayni'kwa kitinebir tiKh'il. Ginake bizey libKha, sanbi'Kha, ts'elam kebdiKha — zikone seb fets'imu zeyyri'iyom wishTawi siwrat akalat — kitinebir aytiKh'ilin.

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*Ginake Amlak netom ziHameqom kifalat ziyada kibret bimihab siga Habiru aqomo,
ab siga mikififall keyhilu. Amlak biflaT niziteris'u nimi'll'al sigau yiqerts'. Nizigodalom
ziMislu kifalat ziyada kibret yihib. Izi gilibT zikone mengisti tegbar iyu dagmay — nay
meweda'eta qedamay kiKhewn, tiHut kili'al, siwir kiKhber.*

Hade kifal mis zisqe kulu kifal misau yisqe. Bi'akal izi Haqi miwKhanu tifiI. Ts'abi'e igriKha tiwqa'e milu'e sigaKha yimilish — gets'Ka yiTimzez, idiKha nab taHti yizirgaH, kal'e igriKha tewesaKhi kibdet yisiKem, nib'at nab a'intiKha yimits'e. Nay Hade ni'ishto kifal qanza nay milu'e siga temokro yiKhewn.

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*Hade kifal mis ziKhber kulu kifal misau yiHgos. Izi kal'e wegen iyu — minalbat
ziKhebede fetena. Kal'e seb mis ziKhber biHaqi kitHgos tiKh'il'do? ArKiKha nisKha
zideleKhayo idil mis tirekib, nay kal'e amani wihbet natiKha bizey afilTo kitiref kelo
mis zifleT, kal'e seb nisKha tiqaleselu zinberKa bota mis zi'wet — kitHgos tiKh'il'do?*

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*Hiji nisKhatKum siga Kristos iKhum, nefsi wekefKum dima kifalu iKhum. Izi qulfi Tiqsi
 iyu — wilqawi, qeT'ta, zeytirif. Pawlos bifilsifna ayziarebin. Ninefsi wekef anbabi
 ats'abi'itu yiqsir "nisKha" yibil. NisKha nay Kristos siga kifal iKha. Te'azabi aykonKan,
 temelkati aykonKan, nay haymanotawi agelgilot teTeqami aykonKan — ziserH,
 agedasi, zeytika'e kifal iKha.*

Scene 15 of 25

[PICTURE: Two teenagers side by side — one looking enviously at the other's gift (shown as a bright light), while their own gift (a different colored light) dims behind them, neglected. A mirror between them shows that comparison distorts both reflections. The envious teen appears smaller; the envied one appears falsely large. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Comparing and competing with gifts destroys community. When you look at someone else's gift with envy, two things happen: your own gift shrinks in your eyes, and their gift becomes distorted — either idolized or resented. Comparison is the thief of calling. The moment you start measuring your gift against someone else's, you stop developing what God gave YOU. The person with the gift of encouragement starts wishing they could preach. The person with the gift of mercy starts resenting that they're not upfront. The person with the gift of administration wonders why they can't prophesy. And meanwhile, their actual gift — the one the body desperately needs — lies undeveloped and unused. Competition turns siblings into rivals. It transforms a body into a beauty contest where only the visible parts matter. Paul's teaching dismantles this entirely: there IS no competition because you are not doing the same job. An eye competing with a hand is absurd — they serve completely different functions. Find your function and fulfill it with excellence, without looking sideways.

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Biwihbetat miwiddarin migibgbibin maHber yizerig. Nay kal'e seb wihbet biqin'i mis tiri'i kilte neger yiKhewn: nay geza'e riisKha wihbet ab a'intiKha yini'is, natom wihbet yiTewawye — yi'ibe wey yits'la'e. Mwiddar seraqi ts'iw'a iyu. WihbetiKa mis nay kal'e kitiqno mis jemerKa Amlak ni'aKha zihbeKa mimi'bal tigidif.

Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: A teenager using their gift (shown as light flowing from their hands) to serve others — the light goes outward toward people in need, not back toward themselves. Behind them, a mirror shows that as they give their gift away, they actually grow brighter and stronger. Self-focused use makes the gift dim; other-focused use makes it shine. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Your gift is not about YOU — it's about serving others. This is perhaps the hardest lesson for young people in a culture that constantly says "express yourself," "find yourself," "be your best self." Spiritual gifts are not given for self-expression or self-fulfillment — they are given for the common good. Paul says it explicitly: "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good." Your gift exists to serve other people. The person with wisdom has it to guide others, not to feel intellectually superior. The person with faith has it to inspire others, not to appear more spiritual. The person with healing has it to bring wholeness to the suffering, not to build a personal platform. When you use your gift for yourself — for recognition, for ego, for status — it withers. It becomes a dead performance. But when you use it to genuinely serve others with no expectation of return, it flourishes and multiplies. Gifts used in love grow; gifts used in pride shrink.

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 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ — ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
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 — ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ

*Wihbetika biza'iba ni'aKha aykonen — niKhal'ot bimgilgal iyu. Izi minalbat biqets'ali
 "geza'e ri'isKha gileTs'," "geza'e ri'isKha riKheb," "zibeleTse geza'e ri'isKha kun" tibil
 bahli nimeniseyyat aziyu ziKhebede timhirti iyu. Menfesawi wihbetat nigeza'e ri'isKha
 migilats' wey geza'e ri'isKha mi'igab zeykone niHabarawi ts'ibuq yiwehab.*

Scene 17 of 25

[PICTURE: A teenager sitting quietly, looking at their own hands with wonder. From within their chest, a soft glow is beginning to emerge — their unique gift awakening. Around them, subtle signs of their gift are visible in their daily life: encouraging notes they've written, a younger child they've helped, a creative project they've made. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Discovering your unique gift — it's already in you. Many young people ask "what is my spiritual gift?" as if it's a mystery to be solved. But often your gift is already operating — you just haven't named it yet. Look at what energizes you: do you come alive when you're helping someone understand a concept? That may be teaching. Do you notice when people are hurting before anyone else does? That may be mercy. Do you naturally organize things and bring order to chaos? That may be administration. Do you find yourself constantly encouraging others? That's likely your gift. Your gift is where your joy meets others' needs. It's what you do naturally that supernaturally impacts people. Ask trusted friends and mentors what they see in you. Pay attention to what others thank you for repeatedly. Notice what fills you up rather than draining you when you serve. Your gift isn't something you need to manufacture — it's something you need to recognize, develop, and deploy. The Spirit already planted it in you.

፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ — ፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡ "፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡?" ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡

ለእኛም ለእኛም ስለእኛ ስለእኛ'ሉ? ለእኛም ስለእኛ ስለእኛም ስለእኛም ስለእኛ ስለእኛ
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Fluy wihbetiKa mirikab — diro abaKha alo. BizuHat meniseyyat "menfesawi wihbetey intay iyu?" ilom yiHatu kem zifitaH misitir zikone. Ginake bizuH gize wihbetiKa diro yiserH alo — ayisemeKhayon tiray. ZeniqesaqiseKa ri'a: Hade seb Hade Hasab kirida'o kitHigiz keleKa hiyaw tiKhewn'do? Mimhar kiKhewn yiKh'il.

Ginake aziyu zi'abi mendedi keriyekum iye. Biza'iba kulom wihbetat — bizuHnetom, agedasnetom, qinu'e sirHom — mis tezarebe Pawlos zisdemim misgar yigebir. Kab wihbetat'win nila'ili zi'abi neger alo. "Aziyu zi'abi mendedi" alo. Nay 1 Qorontos mi'raf 13 fets'imu zitets'aHfe aziyu zifleT nay fiqri ts'Huf iyu ginake biza'iba romantikawi fiqri wey hafeshawi Hiyawnet aykonen.

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 ስብኩም" ስብ ስብ ስብኩም'ስ ስብ ስብኩም ስብ ስብኩም ስብ ስብ ስብኩም
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 ስብኩም ስብ ስብኩም ስብ ስብኩም

*Bilisan sebatin mela'iKhtin intezarebKu fiqri gina zeybley maHres zibele asrazi wey
 zidewele ts'enats'il tiray iye. Pawlos bizibezHe zedinikq wihbetat yijmir bizey fiqri
 bado miwKhanom yi'wiy. Kulu nay seb qwanqwan kem'u'win nay mela'iKhtin kitizareb
 tiKh'il nberKa — nay meweda'eta wihbet rikib — bizey fiqri gina kab awta wets'a'i
 zikone neger aytefrin.*

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 ለእኛ

*Fiqri aqal iya, fiqri lewaH iya. Aytiqeni'in, aytiKhbrin, ayti'ben. Pawlos nifiqri kem
 simi'it zeykone kem bahriy yigelts'. Fiqri aqal iya — nisebat ki'abyu, kiwedqu,
 kimeharu gize tihib bizey qits'betawi wits'it mits'bay. Fiqri lewaH iya — nimibarKh
 megedtat binTifet tideli gudaat kab miwgad tiray zeykone ts'ibuaq mis'ab.*

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 ብሔራዊ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ
 ብሔራዊ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ ስላሴ
 ብሔራዊ ስላሴ

*Fiqri fets'ima aytiwedqin. Ginake tinbitat alewu kiwid'u iyom — lisanat alewu kisqeTu
 iyom — filiTet alo kiHalif iyu. Abzi nay zeze'alem ameleKhaKhta alo: wihbetat
 nigizyawit alem gizyawit mesarHi iyom. Hiji elamoom yigelgilu ginake nizele'alem
 ayTs'enHun. Tinbit kiwida'e mikniyat ab zeze'alem niAmlak gets' nigets' kinifilTo ina.*

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፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ — ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡
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*Hits'an mis zinberKu kem hits'an tezarebKu, kem hits'an HasebKu, kem hits'an
amezazenKu. Abi mis konKu nay hits'annet agebamat gedefKu. Pawlos biza'iba ab
miTqam wihbetat bislet yizareb. Wihbet zelewo hits'an ni'aqalbo, nits'eweta, nigeza'e
ri'isi Tiqmi yiTqemelu. Bisul seb neti Hade wihbet ni'agelgilot, nimhinats', niKhbri
Amlak yiTqemelu.*

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 ስጦጦጦጦጦ ስጦ ስጦ ስጦ ስጦጦጦ ስጦጦጦጦጦ ስጦ ስጦ ስጦጦጦ ስጦጦጦጦ
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 ስጦጦ — "ስጦጦ ስጦ ስጦ"

*Hiji dima imnet, tesfa, fiqri izen seleste yiqerba. Kab'an zi'abeyet gina fiqri iya. Kulu
 mis Halefe — tinbit mis wede'a, lisanat mis abqe'e, filiTet mis temele'a — seleste
 negarrat nizele'alem yiTs'enHu: imnet, tesfa, fiqri. Imnet ab bahriy Amlakn tesfatatun
 mi'iman iyu. Tesfa nay Amlak mets'a'i aminKa mits'bay iyu. Fiqri niAmlakn niKhal'otn
 niTuf miswa'e kinkin iya.*

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Nimengedi fiqri si'abu wihbetat Menfes dima biharerla dileyu. Pawlos "wihbetat ris'u sebat tiray afqiru" aybilin. Kiltiu si'ab — ginake biqinu'e sir'at yibil. Fiqri meseret iya — wihbetat gilts'et iyom. Fiqri sur iya — wihbetat fire iyom. Menfesawi wihbetat biharerta kitideli yigba'e — niAmlak Hitetom, ama'iblom, kitiTqemelom ididat dile.

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*Tegbar: ab siga botaKha mirikab, wihbetat bifiqri miTqam. Bota aleKa. Nay kal'e seb
 bota aykonen — fluy natiKa iyu. Siga Kristos niskha tiray kitimela'o tiKh'il kiftet
 alewo. BahriyKa, temokiroKha, fluy nay wihbet TimretiKa, weledoKha, bahliKha —
 kulu nezi zeytika'e yigebreKa. Kabzi jemir: Amlak wihbetiKa kigeITs'elKa Hiteto.
 Amunat sebat abaKha intay kem ziri'yu Hitetom.*

Discussion Questions

1. What do you think your spiritual gift might be? What clues have you noticed — what energizes you, what do people thank you for, what comes naturally to you that impacts others? How can you begin to develop and use that gift more intentionally this week?

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2. Why does comparing your gift with someone else's destroy community? Have you ever felt jealous of another person's gift or felt worthless because yours seemed less visible? How does Paul's teaching about the body change your perspective on this?

2. ስፍራሽ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ? ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ? ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራሽ ስፍራ ስፍራ?

3. Paul says that without love, even the greatest gifts are "nothing" — just noise. How is love the context for all gifts? What does it look like practically to use a gift WITH love versus using it WITHOUT love? Can you think of examples of each?

3. ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ'ፍ "ስፍራ ስፍራ" — ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ? ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ? ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ'ፍ?

4. What does it mean that the parts that "seem weaker" are actually indispensable? Who are the "hidden" or "quiet" members in your church or community whose contribution is essential but rarely celebrated? How can you honor them?

[illegible]

5. How can you use your gifts to serve others rather than promote yourself? What is the difference between using a gift for God's glory and using it for personal recognition? What specific commitment can you make this week to serve someone with your gift, expecting nothing in return?

[illegible]

A Prayer for Spiritual Gifts and Love

Holy Spirit, thank You for being the generous giver of gifts. Thank You that You have not left us empty-handed but have equipped every believer with something unique and essential for the body of Christ. We ask You today to open our eyes to the gifts You have placed within us — gifts we may not yet have recognized or fully developed.

Reveal to each of us our unique calling and contribution. Show us where we fit in Your body. Help us see that our gift — whether visible or hidden, dramatic or quiet — is indispensable. Remove from us every spirit of comparison, competition, and jealousy. Help us celebrate the gifts of others without diminishing our own, and value our own without despising theirs.

Lord, develop our gifts with excellence. Give us opportunities to practice, to serve, to grow. Bring mentors who can guide us and communities where we can flourish. But above all, above every gift and every ability, fill us with Your love. May love be our foundation, our motivation, and our method. May we never use gifts to promote ourselves but always to build others up.

Teach us that without love, even our best efforts are nothing but noise. Make us patient and kind. Root out envy, boasting, and pride. Help us use every gift You have given in humble, selfless, joyful service to others. Unite us as one body — diverse in gifts but one in Spirit, one in love, one in purpose.

We eagerly desire Your gifts, Lord, but we pursue love above all. Make us the body You designed us to be — every part functioning, every member valued, every gift flowing from love. In the name of Jesus, who gave the greatest gift of all. Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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